

ISSUE 54

AUGUST 16, 2026

LAST WEEK IN TÜRKİYE

A weekly roundup of the top news
and developments in Türkiye



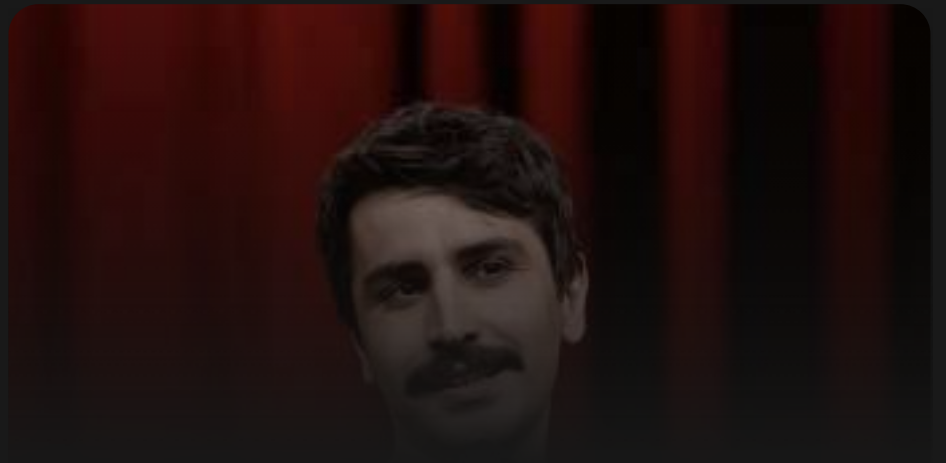
AUGUST 16, 2026

REMINDERS BY NUMBERS



151 DAYS

since Justice Minister Akın Gürlek was asked to explain his 452 lira worth of real estate holdings. No explanation has followed.



43 DAYS

since comedian Deniz Göktaş was arrested. He remains in prison awaiting trial over charges related to his stand-up show.



₺174.4 BILLION

allocated to the Directorate Religious Affairs (Diyanet) in the 2026 budget.



₺8.49 BILLION

spent by the presidency in the first six months of 2025.

That's about ₺32,000 per minute.



AUGUST 16, 2026

CUMHURİYET

ANKARA IMPOSES 15-DAY PROTEST BAN

The Ankara Governor's Office imposed a 15-day ban on demonstrations and public gatherings across the capital starting August 12th.

The decision came as mine workers, veterans and relatives of fallen soldiers continued protests over unpaid wages and demands for equal rights. Police had intervened in several of the demonstrations in the days before the ban.



AUGUST 16, 2026

WORLD PRISON BRIEF

PRISON POPULATION EXCEEDS 433,000

Türkiye's prison population reached 433,520 as of August 3, according to Justice Ministry data, exceeding the country's official prison capacity by 128,564 people.

The figures put prison occupancy at approximately 142 percent, with the prison population having increased by more than 11,000 since June.



AUGUST 16, 2026

BIANET

IMMUNITY FILES SENT TO PARLIAMENT

Immunity files concerning Yeni Parti leader Özgür Özel, Yeni Parti MP Veli Ağbaba and TİP MP Sera Kadıgil were submitted to the Turkish Parliament on August 12.

The files were referred to the Joint Commission of the Constitutional and Justice Committees, beginning the parliamentary process for considering the lifting of their legislative immunity.



AUGUST 16, 2026

YENİ
PARTİ

CUMHURİYET

YENİ PARTİ

ONLINE ÜYELİK

AÇILDI!

Daha güçlü bir gelecek için
sen de aramıza katıl!

YENİ PARTİ STARTS ONLINE MEMBERSHIP

YENİ Parti, Türkiye's new main opposition party, starts its online membership system on August 11.

The party announced that citizens could join through its online platform. Within two days, the party said it had received 110,000 membership applications.



AUGUST 16, 2026

EURONEWS

MABEL MATİZ FACES NEW INVESTIGATION

An investigation was launched into singer Mabel Matiz over the lyrics and music video of his song “Ha Leylim,” according to the İstanbul Chief Public Prosecutor’s Office.

The investigation concerns an alleged offense of obscenity. It comes after Matiz was previously prosecuted over his song “Perperişan” and ultimately acquitted in that case.



AUGUST 16, 2026

EVRENSEL

MAN ARRESTED OVER ERDOĞAN BANNER

A man in Zonguldak's Devrek district was arrested after removing and damaging a banner featuring President Recep Tayyip Erdoğan.

He was initially detained and released, but was later arrested following an objection by the prosecutor.



AUGUST 16, 2026

BIANET

“SÜLEYMANCIAR” INVESTIGATION EXPANDS

A police operation was carried out at an address associated with the Süleymancılar religious community in İstanbul's Ümraniye district on August 14.

The raid followed a wider investigation led by the Ankara Chief Public Prosecutor's Office, in which detention orders were issued for 33 people, including the group's leader Alihan Kuriş.

